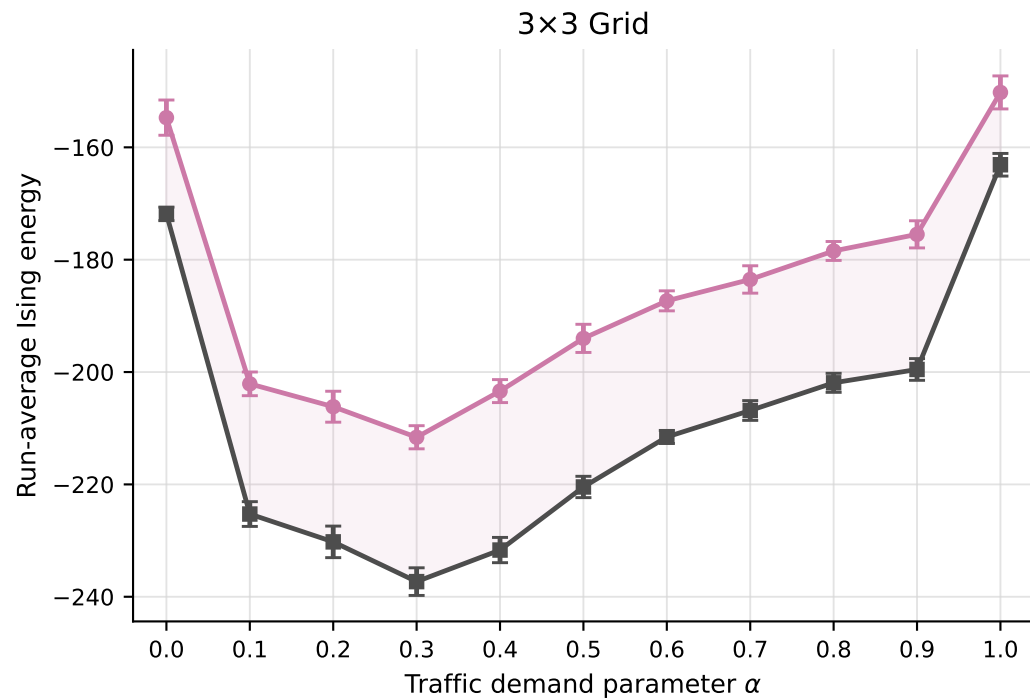
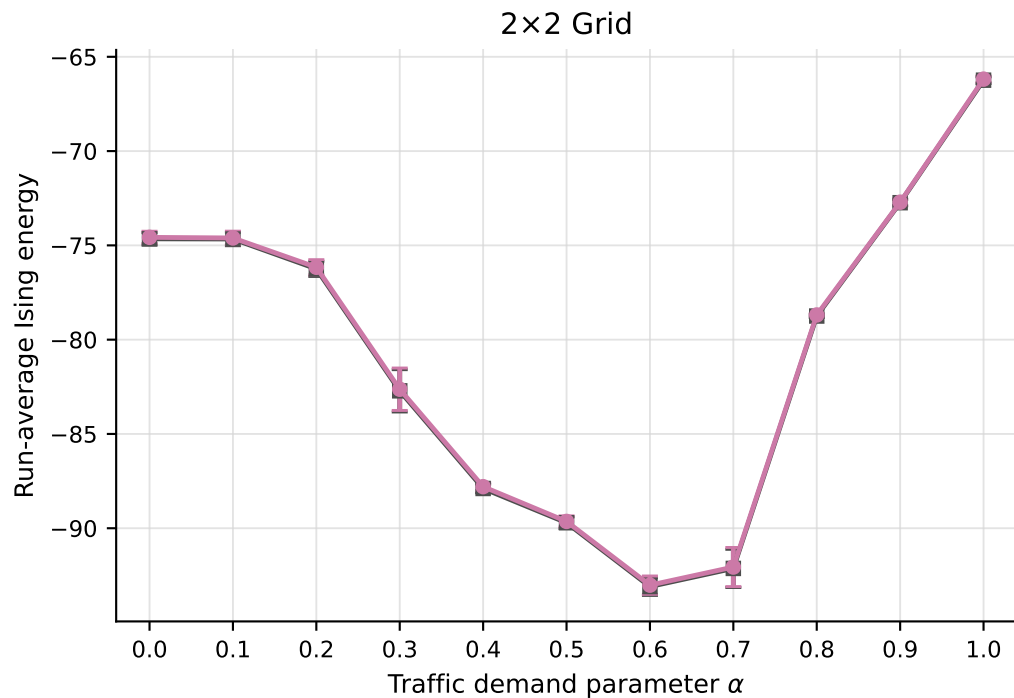


Exact Classical Global Minimum vs QAOA-Selected Energy

Mean optimality gap Exact classical minimum $E_{\min}$ QAOA-selected E_{QAOA}



Points show means across 20 independent runs per condition; error bars are 95% CIs across runs. Each run value averages 600 recorded one-second QAOA controller evaluations.